DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 11

UI designer

Profession 11 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A UI designer designs the screens and components of a digital product: buttons, forms, navigation, layouts and states, in a system the team can reuse.

What professionals do every day

Designs screens from flows, builds a component library with states, applies the style system, checks accessibility and prepares handoff for developers.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Good interfaces make tasks obvious. A component system keeps the product consistent and speeds the team up.

- Inconsistent buttons and forms across screens.
- Missing states (error, empty, loading).
- Handoffs that developers must guess.

Skills you need

- Layout, spacing and typography for screens.
- Components, variants and states.
- Accessibility: contrast, focus, touch targets.
- Design tokens and handoff.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Figma	Component libraries and prototypes	Free starter	Paid plans	www.figma.com
Storybook	Documenting components for developers	Free	Free	storybook.js.org
Material Design guidelines	Design reference from Google	Free	Free	m3.material.io
Apple Human Interface Guidelines	Platform reference	Free	Free	developer.apple.com/design/human-interface-guidelines/

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Design a login screen with all states.

Intermediate	Build a button component with four variants.
Advanced	Create a settings screen using the component library.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Dashboard UI for a SaaS.
- **Intermediate:** Booking app screens.
- **Advanced:** Checkout flow components.

Client-ready portfolio project

A component library of 12 components with states, and a three-screen app flow using them, with handoff notes for developers.

Worked example

Worked example. The primary button has default, hover, focus, pressed and disabled states; focus has a visible outline, and the text pair passes contrast.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Component states and contrast

Business problem: A product team needs a button that is consistent and accessible.

Steps

1. Design the button with five states.
2. Check the text on each background pair with the contrast checker.
3. Add a visible focus outline.
4. Write the handoff note with token names.

Expected output: The component in five states and a handoff note.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Each state is designed and named. The focus outline is required for keyboard users. Token names let developers match the design to the code.

Common mistakes

- Designing only the default state.
- Using colour alone to show status.
- Tiny touch targets on phones.
- No handoff notes.

Freelancing opportunities

- UI design for SaaS and app start-ups.
- Component library projects for product teams.
- Briefs for 'UI design', 'dashboard design', 'Figma design system'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Material Design 3 (official guidelines)
- WCAG 2.2 quick reference

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. **Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in** · **Open the full textbook**. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.